Question ID: 49800634

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Hard

Question

x	y
-18	-48
7	52

The table shows two values of x and their corresponding values of y. In the *xy*-plane, the graph of the linear equation representing this relationship passes through the point $\left(\frac{1}{7},\ a\right)$. What is the value of a?

Answer

A. $-\frac{4}{11}$

B. $-\frac{4}{77}$

C. $\frac{4}{7}$

D. $\frac{172}{7}$

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The linear relationship between x and y can be represented by the equation $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the graph of this equation in the *xy*-plane and b is the *y*-coordinate of the *y*-intercept. The slope of a line between any two points (x_1, y_1) and (x_2, y_2) on the line can be calculated using the slope formula $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$. Based on the table, the graph contains the points $(-18, -48)$ and $(7, 52)$. Substituting $(-18, -48)$ and $(7, 52)$ for (x_1, y_1) and (x_2, y_2), respectively, in the slope formula yields $m = \frac{52 - (-48)}{7 - (-18)}$, which is equivalent to $m = \frac{100}{25}$, or $m = 4$. Substituting 4 for m, -18 for x, and -48 for y in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $-48 = 4(-18) + b$, or $-48 = -72 + b$. Adding 72 to both sides of this equation yields $24 = b$. Therefore, $m = 4$ and $b = 24$. Substituting 4 for m and 24 for b in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $y = 4x + 24$. Thus, the equation $y = 4x + 24$ represents the linear relationship between x and y. It's also given that the graph of the linear equation representing this relationship in the *xy*-plane passes through the point $\left(\frac{1}{7}, a\right)$. Substituting $\frac{1}{7}$ for x and a for y in the equation $y = 4x + 24$ yields $a = 4\left(\frac{1}{7}\right) + 24$, which is equivalent to $a = \frac{4}{7} + \frac{168}{7}$, or $a = \frac{172}{7}$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.